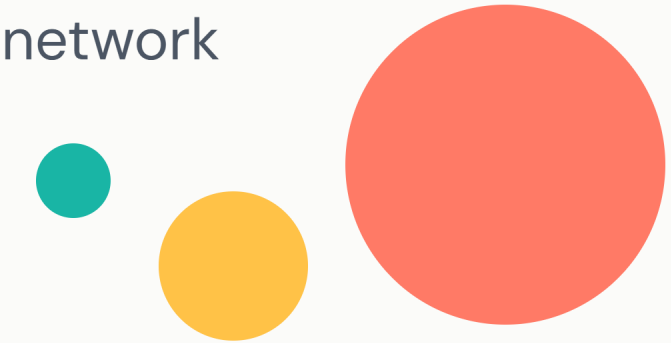
AI COURSE · PROJECT PROPOSAL

Tastelet

Taste personas and movie picks, powered by a neural network



October 2026

THE PROBLEM

Too many movies, too hard to choose

Endless choice

Catalogs are too big to browse one by one.

One-size lists

Popular lists ignore personal taste.

Cold start

A new user has no history to learn from.

THE IDEA

Pick favorites, get a taste profile

STEP 1

Pick

Choose 5 or more movies you love from a poster grid.

STEP 2

Analyze

A neural network learns your taste from your picks.

STEP 3

Discover

See your persona, favorite genres and recommended movies.

AI TECHNIQUES

Three course topics in one project

Neural network	Main topic. Learns taste embeddings and predicts ratings.
Clustering	K-means groups users into taste personas.
KNN baseline	A simple method the neural network must beat.

DATA AND EVALUATION

Real ratings, honest comparison

Data

- MovieLens: about 100k ratings
- TMDB: posters and descriptions

Evaluation

- Baselines: popularity and KNN
- Metrics: RMSE and Hit@10

TECH STACK

Simple, stateless architecture

Frontend

React with Vite, hosted on Vercel.

Backend

FastAPI and PyTorch, hosted on Render.

No accounts and no database: picks are never stored.

PLAN

Four steps to a working demo

Oct 12–14

Data

Load MovieLens, build baselines.

Oct 14–20

Model

Train the network and personas.

Oct 20–27

App

Build the API and frontend, then deploy.

Oct 27–31

Report

Results, slides and demo.

TASTELET

Thank you

Questions and feedback are welcome

